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DJIA 42319.74 ▼ 108.00 0.25% NASDAQ 19298.45 ▼ 0.8% STOXX 600 551.88 ▲ 0.2% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 7/32, yield 4.392% OIL \$63.37 ▲ \$0.52 GOLD \$3,350.70 ▼ \$22.80 EURO \$1.1445 YEN 143.55

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Shares of crypto firm** Circle opened at \$69 on their first day of trading on the NYSE, more than double their initial public offering price, and closed at \$83.23. **B1**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** slipped, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow industrials shedding 0.5%, 0.8% and 0.3%, respectively. **B9**

◆ **Initial claims for jobless benefits** rose for a second straight week, signaling a potentially weakening labor market. **A2**

◆ **Kimberly-Clark struck** a deal of more than \$3 billion for its Kleenex and tissue businesses outside North America, aiming to focus on more-profitable areas. **B1**

◆ **Procter & Gamble said** it would cut 7,000 jobs, or roughly 15% of its nonmanufacturing workforce worldwide, over the next two years. **B1**

◆ **Citigroup will reduce** its technology workforce in China by about 3,500 as part of a restructuring to streamline global operations. **B4**

◆ **Medicare insurer Humana** told congressional staffers that it will support moves that would curtail billing practices worth billions of dollars in extra payments to the industry. **B1**

◆ **Wine and spirits company Brown-Forman** said that it expects organic sales to decline this fiscal year as demand slows amid shifting tariffs and economic uncertainty. **B3**

◆ **Dongfeng shares** plunged after the disclosure that the Chinese automaker isn't currently restructuring its business just months after it announced plans to do so. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **Long-simmering tensions** between Trump and Musk burst into the open as the two men traded barbs and insults, signaling the rupture of a relationship once highly consequential to U.S. politics. **A1, A4**

◆ **Trump spoke with Chinese leader Xi Jinping** and suggested after the call that the issue of exports of rare-earth minerals, which are critical to the U.S. auto industry, had been addressed. **A1**

◆ **The U.S. trade deficit** collapsed in April, shrinking by more than half as tariffs took a huge bite out of imports. **A1**

◆ **A Boston federal judge** issued a temporary restraining order blocking Trump's latest effort to prohibit international students from enrolling at Harvard University. **A3**

◆ **Iran ordered** thousands of tons of ballistic-missile fuel chemicals from China, seeking to rebuild its military prowess as it discusses the future of its nuclear program with the U.S. **A9**

◆ **Trump said Russia and Ukraine** weren't ready to make peace and hostilities might need to continue before they were ready to come to the table. **A8**

◆ **Israel's military said** it had retrieved the remains of an American-Israeli couple who were killed during the Hamas-led Oct. 7, 2023, attack and whose bodies were taken into Gaza. **A7**

◆ **Trump's new travel ban** is expected to be harder to fight in court than previous iterations, after the administration learned lessons from a first-term battle over the policy's legality. **A3**

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Fiery Trump-Musk Feud Breaks Out

President threatens federal subsidies, contracts with the mogul's companies

WASHINGTON—Long-simmering tensions between President Trump and Elon Musk burst into the open on Thursday, as the two men traded barbs and insults, signaling the rupturing of a relationship that had been one of

the most consequential in modern American politics.

Trump, publicly addressing Musk's latest attacks on his signature tax bill for the first time, said Thursday he was disappointed in his former White House adviser and suggested he was suffering from "Trump derangement syndrome."

Musk, who spent hundreds of millions of dollars to help get Trump re-elected, shot back in real time on social media that Trump was ungrateful and

By *Brian Schwartz, Siobhan Hughes and Natalie Andrews*

wouldn't be sitting in the Oval Office without his support.

The feud could have serious consequences for both the president and the billionaire businessman. The Tesla chief executive mused Thursday on social media about starting a new political party and encouraged Republicans to side with him in

his spat with Trump, as the electric-vehicle maker's shares declined 14% for the day. And Trump threatened to eliminate government subsidies and contracts for Musk's businesses.

The escalating dispute sent the carmaker to a decline of around \$152.4 billion in market value, its biggest one-day decline on record, according to Dow Jones Market Data. Tesla has now shed around \$237.2 billion in market value over the past five sessions, notching

its worst five-day market-cap loss since the stretch ended Jan. 2. More than 276 million Tesla shares changed hands during Thursday's session, the highest one-day trading volume since January 2023.

The recriminations intensified Thursday afternoon when Musk told his 220 million X followers that Trump "is in

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◆ **Sudden clash dismays GOP lawmakers**..... A4

Coco's Crisp as Win Puts Her in French Open Finals



ENCORE! Coco Gauff of the U.S. won her match against Loïs Boisson in straight sets Wednesday in the French Open, advancing to the singles final against Aryna Sabalenka on Saturday. It will be the Gauff's second final at the event since 2022. **WSJ.com**

New Rules of War at Sea Test U.S. Navy

Proliferation of cheap missiles and drones made Houthis a surprisingly difficult foe

By **STEPHEN KALIN AND SHELBY HOLLIDAY**

The evening of May 6, an F/A-18 Super Hornet was coming in for a landing on the USS Harry S. Truman aircraft carrier in the Red Sea. An onboard mechanism to slow it down failed, and the \$67 million aircraft slid off the carrier's runway and into the water.

It was the third fighter jet that the Truman had lost in less than five

months, and came hours after President Trump surprised Pentagon officials with the announcement that the U.S. had reached a truce with the Houthis in Yemen. The Truman had arrived at the Red Sea in December 2024 to battle the Iran-aligned militants—joining a campaign filled with heavy exchanges and close calls that strained the U.S. Navy.

Officials are now dissecting how a scrappy adversary was able to test the

world's most capable surface fleet. The Houthis proved to be a surprisingly difficult foe, engaging the Navy in its fiercest battles since World War II despite fighting from primitive quarters and caves in one of the world's poorest countries.

The Houthis benefited from the pro-

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◆ **Iran taps China for missile fuel**..... A9

High Court Bolsters Workers' Reverse Bias Suits

By **JAN WOLFE AND ERIN MULVANEY**

WASHINGTON—The Supreme Court made it easier for workers to sue for reverse discrimination in a unanimous ruling that allowed a woman to pursue a claim that she was denied a job promotion because she is straight.

The decision on Thursday revives a lawsuit brought by Marlean Ames, who alleged the Ohio state agency where she works denied her a promotion, and then demoted her, because she is heterosexual. She said that both her old job and the one she had sought were given to gay people. Her supervisor at the time was also gay.

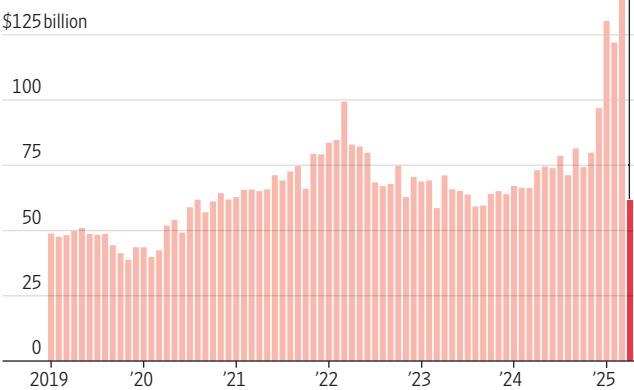
The high court, in an opinion by Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson, said a Cincinnati-based appeals court erred by requiring Ames to show "background circumstances" suggesting the employer was hostile to straight people—which wouldn't have been required had a gay employee claimed discrimination.

The ruling resolves a split

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Trade Deficit Shrinks by More Than Half

U.S. trade deficit in goods and services, monthly



Note: Seasonally adjusted
Source: Commerce Department

By **JUSTIN LAHART AND ANTHONY DEBARROS**

The U.S. trade deficit collapsed in April, shrinking by more than half as tariffs took a huge bite out of imports.

The trade deficit narrowed to a seasonally adjusted \$61.6 billion in April, the Commerce Department reported on Thursday, its lowest level since September 2023. That was down sharply from the record \$138.3 billion it hit in March, when businesses were racing to bring in imports before the "Liberation Day" tariffs that President Trump imposed April 2.

In dollars, the drop was the largest monthly change in the goods and services deficit in data back to 1992. By percentage, the 55% drop was second only to a 59% decrease recorded in February 1992.

Economists said that businesses were still working through their inventories of products that they hurried to buy earlier in the year. Still, April's return to a deficit level more reminiscent of 2023 is likely to prove short-lived, some economists said. That is because businesses are still highly uncertain about where Trump's tariffs will eventually

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These Mrs. Lincolns Aren't Crazy About This Play Either

Impersonators say Mary Todd is misjudged and a hit Broadway show isn't helping

By **JACOB PASSY**

Mary Todd Lincoln is killing it on Broadway.

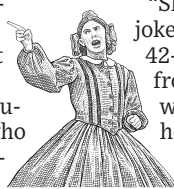
But if you think the women who devote much of their lives to portraying the former first lady are celebrating, you don't know these Marys.

Within the community of hobbyists who impersonate Abraham and Mary, her depiction in popu-

lar culture is a sore subject. Marys say they carry the burden of both her bulky outfits and a long history of indignities and misconceptions about her mental state.

"She is easily the butt of jokes," said Laura Keyes, a 42-year-old library director from Peoria, Ill. "It's sad when I know more about her, but I see that as part of my duty to portray her accurately."

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Stage fright

TOMORROW



AYO EDEBIRI

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